📝 Notes

Aug 14, 2026

Techjays Originals

Invited Philip Samuelraj Ananthu Vijayan Aparna Pillai

Attachments Techjays Originals

Meeting records Transcript

Summary

Creative direction and narrative refinement discussions established visual themes and specific character backstory updates for the project.

Visual and Cinematic Adjustments
Discussions focused on improving shot spacing and correcting unrealistic jail scenes for better cultural alignment. The team confirmed a shift toward more traditional, realistic filming styles rather than standard AI sci-fi tropes.

Narrative Development Strategy
The project will mirror the thematic structure of The Count of Monte Cristo, emphasizing a transformative middle arc. It was decided that the protagonist must maintain a thoughtful, driven persona throughout the narrative.

Lighting and Technical Standards
References to dark, moody cinematography styles were established to guide future lighting and color grading decisions. The team emphasized the need to avoid flat visuals by enhancing depth and saturation.

Decisions

Needs Further Discussion

- **Visual style and grading research** The team is evaluating the implementation of specific lighting and lens techniques to visually differentiate the film's thematic stages, based on the color grading style observed in the movie Limitless.

Aligned

- **Shot framing distance adjusted** The shot framing for the scene is adjusted to increase the distance between the two characters to achieve a more cinematic look.
- **Prison scene concept revised** The prison scene narrative is updated to remove the digging concept in favor of a realistic depiction of cellmates who are learning, with specific adjustments to character attire and physical appearance to match Indian jail standards.
- **Character scar addition** The character transformation design is updated to include a prominent facial scar, signifying the physical trauma and toughening experienced by the protagonist.
- **Realistic production strategy prioritized** The project strategy is set to focus on traditional realistic film generation to demonstrate that traditional cinematic styles can be AI-generated, moving away from the common industry trend of sci-fi content.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: Helpful or Not Helpful

Next steps

- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan] Adjust Scene Distance: Adjust the distance between the two characters in the cinematic scene.
- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan] Revise Prison Scenes: Revise the prison scenes to reflect greater realism. This includes removing the digging concept and updating character appearances to include white uniforms and light stubble rather than long beards.
- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan] Add Facial Scar: Incorporate a prominent facial scar into the character design to highlight the torturous experiences of the lead character.
- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan, Philip Samuelraj] Research Visual Methods: Research professional lens usage and shooting methods to convey specific visual moods and themes throughout the narrative.
- [ ] [Ananthu Vijayan] Enhance Scene Depth: Enhance scene depth and color quality to ensure the visual composition remains dynamic and prevents a flat aesthetic.

Details

- **Trailer Progress and Resolution**: Philip Samuelraj expresses approval of the trailer's current direction. They discuss the existing 720p resolution, and Philip Samuelraj confirms that they will update it later (00:02:04).
- **Cinematic Shot Spacing**: Philip Samuelraj provides feedback on a specific shot where two characters appear too close, suggesting that they should be positioned further apart to improve the cinematic quality. Regarding the reactions of bystanders in the scene, Philip Samuelraj expresses mixed feelings, but Ananthu Vijayan concludes that the current level of shock is acceptable for the trailer (00:03:42).
- **Jail Scene Realism**: Philip Samuelraj identifies the jail scene as unrealistic, noting that prisoners in India typically do not have long beards and that digging is not a concept applicable to Indian jails. They suggest modifying the scene to show the characters as cellmates who are talking and learning, potentially

wearing white shirts and shorts with a cross necklace, while keeping the main character's facial hair to a stubble rather than a long beard (00:04:58).

- **Character Development and Backstory**: Philip Samuelraj proposes detailing the character's background, such as being branded a traitor to India for helping an LTTE individual and carrying a specific letter. Philip Samuelraj suggests depicting a harsh transition where the character undergoes torture, which results in a prominent facial scar, similar to a French style, that is partially hidden by the beard and refined look the character adopts after escaping (00:05:57).
- **Narrative Structure and Thematic Essence**: Philip Samuelraj emphasizes that the story must capture the essence of "The Count of Monte Cristo," ensuring the protagonist remains a thoughtful, driven character rather than acting blindly. They discuss the narrative arc, noting that the middle section should be brutal and transformative, and the final act should highlight the contrast between the character's lack of support system despite their newfound wealth, power, and elegance (00:08:26).
- **Visual Tone and Lighting Research**: Philip Samuelraj suggests researching how lens choices and lighting can effectively convey different moods. Citing Christopher Nolan's "The Dark Knight" as an example, Philip Samuelraj explains that the film utilizes a consistently dark feel even during daytime, which serves as a technique to maintain a specific visual theme (00:09:34).
- **Visual Reference for Color Grading**: Philip Samuelraj discusses the 2011 film "Limitless" as a visual reference, noting how the film uses color grading and brightness shifts—such as when the character takes a drug called NCB—to visually represent changes in the character's state and environment from dark to bright (00:12:49).
- **Scheduling and Project Urgency**: Philip Samuelraj and Ananthu Vijayan agree to meet next Tuesday to review progress, with Philip Samuelraj stressing the importance of moving fast (00:14:53).
- **Industry Trends and Visual Quality**: Ananthu Vijayan mentions the team is using the Hicksfield platform, which recently released a feature film. Philip Samuelraj notes that many AI-generated films gravitate toward sci-fi because it is technically easier, but they intend to achieve a realistic, traditional film style. Philip Samuelraj advises Ananthu Vijayan to monitor scenes to ensure they do

not look "flat" and to focus on adding depth and color. Aparna Pillai confirms there is no further input to add (00:16:07).

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📖 Transcript

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00:02:04

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah, I'm good. How are

Philip Samuelraj: Good, good, good. And Anto,

Ananthu Vijayan: you?

Philip Samuelraj: I wanted to say great the direction actually uh the way the uh trailer is going is actually lovely. Okay, wonderful work.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah, thank

Philip Samuelraj: I just wanted to set this just to you know give you my thoughts.

Ananthu Vijayan: you.

Philip Samuelraj: You already might be making thinking of those changes and so on but I just want to give uh uh my thoughts.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Let me share and play. Wait, let Um, uh, all of this is good.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: I don't

Philip Samuelraj: Uh, like I I mean the direction that it is going,

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: know.

Philip Samuelraj: this is still 720p, right?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: 720. Okay. And then we'll change

Ananthu Vijayan: 720

Philip Samuelraj: it.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Karen P and the CL

Philip Samuelraj: The only thing here is okay this looks very cinematic that two guys are very closely looking.

00:03:42

Philip Samuelraj: It should be there should be at least some amount of distance. The view maybe can start from there but these guys should be looking from far

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: off.

Ananthu Vijayan: okay. Okay. Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. Are the same?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: for

Philip Samuelraj: That's one feedback because it looks like they are too close

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: every

Philip Samuelraj: here. Shouldn't there be a little bit more shock from the people or this is fine your thoughts? I'm actually divided.

Ananthu Vijayan: It's okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Huh?

Ananthu Vijayan: I think like this is okay if we Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: For the trailer it is fine, right? If he put out the scene then it is fine.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. And uh this is the part right this part. No this this part in the present part uh we definitely need to revisit. Okay, because this becomes too unrealistic.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: We need to make sure that it is as closer to reality.

00:04:58

Philip Samuelraj: Um like I was just taking prisoners in India are actually not allowed to wear like long beards.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Maybe we can saying hey because this guy is a priest he always had it. Maybe he has a cross hanging over and they usually wear white only. Okay. H white shorts, white uh shirt and they're pretty inate. Maybe there is stubble um in the hero's face. Stubble but not like long beard or something. Um and can be digging. They are not digging at all. Okay, they are just cellmates. That's why we need to because digging as a concept in Indian jails don't work. They're not like actually fully locked in that they have to dig out.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh man.

Philip Samuelraj: You get it right? as a concept alone doesn't work.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: So that's not needed at all. They just maybe just cellmates where they are talking, they're learning. I had one more interesting idea,

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: right?

00:05:57

Philip Samuelraj: Yes, even in the transformation. one of the transformation.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: Let me actually go to this screen. Um like this is so cool that you know you come the characterization is like uh you've come up with this very nice uh

very fresh innocent uh look right which is very good. This innocent uh fresh look is very very good.

Ananthu Vijayan: okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Fantastic. So I think as the transition into uh even this dark bearded and so on maybe what we can have is a characterist look at this the sensitivity of it. Okay. Uh this boy is actually being branded as a traitor to India because he just all he did was in the sea he helped a LT guy sinking and he had a letter that he you know uh was you know supposed to be given. Sounds good. So the other part also that we can do is that he was actually had uh uh torture

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: or something like that. One of the toughening of that soft character, you understand?

00:07:12

Philip Samuelraj: People find that it is okay to actually torture the character. So they hit him and they can actually have a facial scar similar to the French

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: one like you know a very prominent facial scar like a facial scar as well which somewhere like this maybe so that it also gets hidden by the beard and the refined look.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay then.

Philip Samuelraj: in in the post escape. Okay. Scars, you know the So, we can that's a character line that I'm thinking. What are your

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah,

Philip Samuelraj: thoughts?

Ananthu Vijayan: that that's good only actually. Uh I didn't think of it actually, but it makes sense.

Philip Samuelraj: Yeah. And the same way in those lines with respect to character lines uh think that way right it's just the flow as long as we keep true to the essence um uh that's you know I can I'll move from here what I'm thinking is as long as we keep true

to the essence of the count of Montikica real story because why it captivates is that the truth

00:08:26

Ananthu Vijayan: Huh?

Philip Samuelraj: and you watch the PBS series right you saw Not it's it's an elaborate web that he actually spreads. It's the ultimate driven story and it is not also a blind driven story. It's not like the blind driven story.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: The hero is also thinking is this the right thing to do? Am I doing the right thing? And the priest actually wants him. If you you saw that right? Hey, before planning revenge, dig your own grave. You're going to have that and in our character transitions it should be the middle part should be also very brutal.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: Oh happy so lucky everything is going well only for initially right sudden change and the middle part is brutal but also transformative.

Ananthu Vijayan: okay then.

Philip Samuelraj: The suffering is brutal at the same time transformative and the last part also

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: becomes it's like this guy actually did not in the beginning also he did not have anything very poor also happy he had all the happiness in the wealth he had

00:09:34

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: people now in the last part the contrast should be is that the hero doesn't have the people that he wants but he has everything else

Ananthu Vijayan: Um. Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: money power all of those that should also be contrasted. Elegance all of that is there. So that that's that um contrast should be there so that it plays along very well. We'll a lot of it why I'm saying it even in the uh uh right now is that as you think about it uh we'll have to frame it. One other interesting thing I read about uh Anand was um uh like for example even from a lens before people used to use even from a lens right people use for brighter themes they use a brighter lens for darker themes they use you know something and to even convey the somber moods that's why you know certain movies actually look that way. Maybe that is something that we can look at just to research this because then the movie

Ananthu Vijayan: Looks okay.

Philip Samuelraj: will clearly be three buds, right?

00:11:10

Philip Samuelraj: three uh threepronged theme even visually.

Ananthu Vijayan: lens in the sense of what you said is the some movies will be like the When we say about the past, is that something like

Philip Samuelraj: Let

Ananthu Vijayan: that?

Philip Samuelraj: me let me I read about it somewhere. I did not recently look. Let me see. Uh let me actually do my research. You also do you see some of the movies look bright warm the screen itself

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay then.

Philip Samuelraj: looks bright warm and so on. You see you look at um uh the dark night

Ananthu Vijayan: Uh,

Philip Samuelraj: um Christopher Nolan's dark night. the movie itself will be fully dark even when it is shot during the day. There's kind of a dark feel to it.

Ananthu Vijayan: okay.

Philip Samuelraj: I think they use some kind of shooting methods.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: What I'm what I'm trying to say is the mood also should be conveyed in the screen like from the beauty and the laughter and the warmth initially the darkness and then the coldness of the revenge at the

00:12:49

Ananthu Vijayan: H okay then. Uh I think in the logo movie which I used as reference also they are using this dark like from the beginning to the last like the theme will be like the darker I think I'll research on it.

Philip Samuelraj: H I still don't know one thing. One thing let me let me let me actually as through the movie. Uh see uh there's this movie called Limitless. Okay,

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: let me exactly pull the screen. Okay, it's called Limitless. It came in 2011.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: The first 5 minutes or so of the movie or 10 minutes of the movie will be like this only

Ananthu Vijayan: H.

Philip Samuelraj: even shot in New York during the day.

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: Okay. But then he will have a drug called NCB, you see? And then they'll actually make it like as if as if a bulb turned on. But then the entire movie will actually become bright. You

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: shouldn't make you this upset.

00:14:18

Philip Samuelraj: understand?

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: What is it for her to come back a half read article some PBS documentary

Ananthu Vijayan: Where?

Philip Samuelraj: Uh yeah.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: At the beginning of the film,

Philip Samuelraj: See that?

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: we see the main character named Eddie Mora,

Philip Samuelraj: See this one this hole is like very dark

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: a failed writer who dreams of that very book capable of making him famous and rich.

Philip Samuelraj: even when he goes out see his

Ananthu Vijayan: Uh.

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: He spends and hopes for better.

Philip Samuelraj: media is like even this looks dark and so on

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Eddie himself was sure everything was fine between them.

Ananthu Vijayan: There you

Philip Samuelraj: right and then that's

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: She moved out of state 100%ing payment for rent. He's uncertainty in the stream of finished clean.

Ananthu Vijayan: go.

Philip Samuelraj: it the after this you look at it

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: The apartment is all Vernon's last meeting with Eddie and Loon offers Eddie to look at a list of

Philip Samuelraj: it's the whole everything becomes bright and so on.

00:14:53

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: companies and seen in movies and this perfect knowing in advance what her.

Philip Samuelraj: It was a really good uh uh what you call it way to

Philip Samuelraj's Presentation: Next action will be fight the looming threat of arrest.

Philip Samuelraj: showcase. Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Um the just this is all just a nice to have and for you to think think on those things. Um any did you do you need anything else from me and

Ananthu Vijayan: No, I think currently everything's okay. I think

Philip Samuelraj: everything's okay?

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Wonderful. Um yeah, keep sending all the updates. I'll keep providing you feedback. Uh let's meet on uh next Tuesday then. Okay.

Ananthu Vijayan: Okay.

Philip Samuelraj: Uh but let's move fast.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Looks like a lot of people are doing trying things like this.

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah. Like that Higfield team itself released one feature filament uh we are using Hicksfield know like that platform.

Philip Samuelraj: Oh.

Ananthu Vijayan: So they themselves released one feature film recently.

00:16:07

Philip Samuelraj: Oh. What is it called? Oh, what are they?

Ananthu Vijayan: Uh some Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: Sci-fi film. Uh,

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: see that's the part also I want to change which is why you're going for something realistic now, right? is that everybody is doing

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh,

Philip Samuelraj: sci-fi because it is easy for AI

Ananthu Vijayan: there.

Philip Samuelraj: generated but we want to change the view that traditional films can be a generated correct okay and then even the scenes what are things the other feedback

Ananthu Vijayan: Yeah.

Philip Samuelraj: is when you're thinking about it what are things that you can do to add more depth to

Ananthu Vijayan: Oh.

Philip Samuelraj: it. Sometimes what I've seen is sometimes a scenes look flat. Not our trailer so far. Any depth to it, more color to it. Anything that we can do,

Ananthu Vijayan: Huh?

Philip Samuelraj: just keep keep your eye on it. Okay, sounds good. Cool. Anything else you want to add? I think she's out.

Aparna Pillai: No, no,

Philip Samuelraj: Okay, awesome then. Thanks,

Aparna Pillai: no.

Philip Samuelraj: Anto. Thanks, Ananthu. Let's make some magic happen though. We are making some magic happen. Okay, have fun. Okay, see you.

Ananthu Vijayan: negative voice. Yes.

Philip Samuelraj: Bye-bye.

Transcription ended after 00:17:50

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